

This summary is written to compare the Diffusion of Innovation (DOI) Model developed in 1962 by E.M. Rogers to the white paper “New Approaches to Energy Hardware Innovation and Incubation” written by David J. Garfield, Kate E. Moore, Richard Adams in 2019.

The DOI model focuses mainly on the culture types surrounding innovation. As with all change, some will be encouraged and some will be resisted. Comparing the two ends of the extremes verbalized by the DOI, “Innovators” are characterized as willing to adapt and early to change/shift, and can handle ambiguity and uncertainty; whereas the “Laggards” value tradition, and will be resistant to change.

The white paper focuses on different models that are being used to support innovation. As discussed in class, there can be people who have great ideas and are inventors, but they are not entrepreneurs because they cannot commit to making their idea and actuality and marketable. The white paper talks about different large companies having innovation programs; such as the Wells Fargo Innovation Incubator that offers lab/equipment access, technology testing/validation/demonstration support, and offers different types of introductions, all with the support of “non-dilutive” funding. Programs such as these, that offer various formats of intense support, and also funding, help make different innovations a reality that would otherwise not come to be.

The DOI does not account for what can happen when standards are changed and support is given to innovation. When companies are being pushed by the government to be more sustainable, they find new ways to encourage growth. Companies recognize that there is value in supporting growth in areas of their interest.